"Is agriculture confined only to villages? What other works do the villagers do?"

"What will a village look like uncle?" interrupted Inba.

"Agriculture is the primary occupation. There won't be any kind of facilities like our cities. At the same time, they get their basic needs fulfilled easily. There are small shops. Vegetables are grown in abundance, just like rice and pulses. Though the sugar that is added in our milk, coffee and tea is produced in sugar mills, the raw material sugarcane is cultivated in villages. From chilies to mustard, all those provisions used for food are grown in villages."

"Wow! My mother told me that these things are very expensive. Therefore, the villagers must be so wealthy!" said Adithya.

"No, not like that. They are just producers. Their products are bought and sold by some mediators. So, the farmers get very little money".

"What a pity! But the villages are the real shadows of cities", exclaimed Anandhan.

"Even Gandhiji has said that the **villages are the backbone of our country**".



"Yes, what a wonderful saying!" said Kavin excitedly.

At that time, the mobile phone rang. Mohan attended the phone. Vimalan's mother Ponni had called.

"What are you chatting about with the children for so long? The food is ready. Bring them home", saying so, she cut the call.

"Children, come, let's go home. Food is ready" Mohan got up and the children followed him with joy.

Inba asked, "Uncle, you said how villages are important. Aren't cities important?"

"No Inba. Both cities and villages are important on their own".

"If it is so, tell us about the importance of cities", asked Inba again.

"That is good. I will tell you. More than 50 percentage of the world's populations live in cities. In our state Tamil Nadu, 47 percentage of the people are in cities,.

"Wow!" they exclaimed.

"Not only that. Tamil Nadu is well developed in secondary and tertiary activities as well. These are city centered activities."

"We feel very proud to hear this uncle. Tell us about those activities".

Uncle Mohan said, "Well, apart from this, employment opportunities are more in cities than villages. People involved in small scale industries and unorganized sector are mostly found in cities."

"We don't understand."

"In villages, there are only a few saloons and laundry shops. But, in cities the number of such small scale workers are more. This results in additional income in cities."

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